

N04 FOOD ADVERTISING | O (MAX : 1 PT)

Intent : Encourage the selection and consumption of healthier food choices through advertising and messaging.

Summary : This WELL feature requires healthy food advertising and nutritional messaging.

Issue : Billions of dollars are spent annually on food marketing and advertising around the world to overwhelmingly promote highly processed products, including sugar-sweetened beverages, breakfast cereals and fast foods.¹ Food advertising and marketing is ubiquitous and takes several forms, including direct and indirect advertising, product sale contracts and sponsored materials. Children and youth are particularly susceptible to food advertising.² Research has found a strong association between advertising for non-nutritious foods and children's behavioral and mental health.² Exposure to unhealthy food advertising increases food consumption in children but not adults.³ Moreover, the marketing and advertising of high-calorie, low-nutrient foods and beverages increases children's preference and intake of unhealthy foods and beverages.⁴ In adults, exposure to food advertising is shown to influence food choices and eating behaviors.⁵

Solutions : Healthy food advertising has been shown to increase the selection of healthier items and may have a stronger impact than anti-obesity advertising on shaping eating behaviors.⁶ These interventions have been effective in a variety of food settings including, cafeterias, corner stores, grocery stores and supermarkets.⁷⁻¹¹

PART 1 OPTIMIZE FOOD ADVERTISING (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces:

1: Food advertising

If foods and beverages are sold or provided on a daily basis by (or under contract with) the project owner, the following requirements are met:

- a.
Sugar-sweetened beverages are not advertised or promoted.¹²
- b.
Deep-fried food options are not advertised or promoted.¹³
- c. Deep-fried food options are not displayed under heat lamps.

2: Nutritional messaging

All dedicated eating spaces and points of sale contain at least two different instances of messaging that promote one of the following:

- a. The consumption of fruits and vegetables.¹³
- b.
The consumption of drinking water.^{14,15}

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